Q. How would you assess the five years of central rule?

OMAR ABDULLAH: I find it very difficult to [find anything to] write home about, other than the fact that at least the overt sort of separatist politics seems to have kind of muted. If Engineer Rashid does well, I think it's fair to say that the government of India has failed even in controlling that sort of politics.

MEHBOOBA MUFTI: The biggest achievement of this government is that they have brought the plebiscite and the self-determination sentiment to the forefront. Engineer Rashid was being accused of funding terror—still people voted for him. That tells you what the basic sentiment of Kashmir is.

JITENDRA SINGH: Apart from restoring law and order and providing infrastructure, there has been the opening up of the start-up sector and industry avenues because all this has started very late. For example, we have two industrial parks coming up in Jammu and Kashmir that will make a big difference.

TARIQ HAMEED KARRA Their model of Kashmir is just a *jumla*. It is really a model of oppression, suppression, depression and all other sorts of pressures on the people of Jammu and Kashmir.

ENGINEER RASHID: What they have achieved is that they terminated government employees, and they are labelling every Kashmiri who is calling for resolution of the Kashmir issue anti-national. What they have achieved is reducing the gap between Jammu and Kashmir because now even the people of Jammu feel they have been cheated by the Modi government.

SAJAD LONE: The most important quality in a government is that you are answerable to the masses. After five years, you must seek votes to stay. That's the beauty of democracy. That beauty is missing from this government. And so it's ugly in its current structure because it lacks democracy.

ALTAF BUKHARI: There is no great revolution they brought about in development. Where is the Mughal tunnel or the ones in Gurez and Thangdar? They say they have brought Rs 70,000 crore investment. Show me even Rs 7,000 crore that they brought. Kashmir and Kashmiris are in a financial mess. There is no business. There is no money. Prices of land have gone down 50 per cent. There are no jobs. We have 16 lakh unemployed graduates and postgraduates.

RAVINDER RAINA: Peace, prosperity and brotherhood are the main achievements. People are moving around freely, there is no stone-pelting, there is no fear psychosis; schools, colleges and universities are open. The phrase 'Kashmir is heaven' is becoming a reality. ■



"There is no revolution in development. Kashmir is in a financial mess. There is no business, no money, no jobs. Prices of land have gone down 50 per cent"

— ALTAF BUKHARI



"The BJP model of Kashmir is just a *jumla*. It is oppression, suppression and depression"

— TARIQ HAMEED KARRA



"Peace and prosperity have been our achievement. The phrase 'Kashmir is heaven' is becoming a reality"

— RAVINDER RAINA